

able with Bitcoin-Qt, MultiBit, Armory and Electrum being the most popular ones.

2. Mobile wallets

Adding an extra layer of flexibility gives you the option of carrying your Bitcoin wallet around with you on your smartphone. Most of these clients are free and some of them link up to your NFC so you can pay using the same at stores that accept Bitcoins.



3. Web-service

If you don't want to worry about hosting your precious Bitcoins on your personal computer or mobile device then you have the option of web-services where all you need to do is make an account.



Reliability

The whole centralised aspect of Bitcoins brings a debilitating effect to it and that is reliability. The wallet is the one place where your Bitcoins stay, there is no backup unless you make one. Real world has banks that offer insurance but none of the applications you download or the web-services you opt for gives you any guarantee. Quite simply because they can't, while the transactions can be tracked easily the identity of the person owning the account cannot be unless they choose to. So that being said, the software based clients hosted on your machines are the safest. You can make plenty of backups and sync them whenever you make a transaction. The probability of losing all backups simultaneously is pretty low.

Mobile apps are similarly reliable but certain apps were removed from their respective stores [Coinbase was removed from the App store] so that's there. This doesn't mean loss of Bitcoins but those who'd downloaded it could still use it. Also losing your mobile phone meant you'd lose your Bitcoins to some lucky pickpocket.

Websites can go down at any moment and should be used as an intermediary if you care about privacy. Hosting your Bitcoins solely on a web-service is the least recommended option.